

6 280100 002354

FRIDAY
JULY 10, 2026
MUHARRAM 25, 1448

TRUSTED NEWS SINCE 1978

gulfnews.com
GULF NEWS



LIVE
UPDATES

800
ALFRED



insuranceMARKET.ae™
Google 4.8/5 Rating ★★★★★ 30,000+ Reviews



EASY TRAVEL
INSURANCE



800
ALFRED

31546022 01

UAE, KUWAIT STRESS STABILITY, PEACE

GCC: Attack on one member is attack on all; Gargash: Gulf unity 'an absolute necessity'

DUBAI

BY STEPHEN N. R.
Senior Associate Editor

The UAE and Kuwait underscored the importance of strengthening the foundations of stability and lasting peace across the Middle East during talks between President His Highness Sheikh Mohamed Bin Zayed Al Nahyan and Kuwait Emir Sheikh Meshal Al Ahmad Al Jaber Al Sabah yesterday.

The leaders exchanged views on regional and international issues, including developments in the Middle East. The talks came as Iran resumed attacks on Kuwait, Bahrain, Qatar and Jordan, raising fresh concerns over regional security.

The UAE condemned the renewed hostile attacks by Iran on Gulf countries and Jordan. The Ministry of Foreign Affairs affirmed that these hostile attacks constitute a flagrant violation of the sovereignty of Bahrain and Kuwait, and a threat to their security and stability.

Strengthening unity

Dr Anwar Gargash, Diplomatic Adviser to the UAE President, stressed that strengthening unity among the Gulf Cooperation Council (GCC) states is essential to confronting threats to the region's security and stability.

In a post on X, Gargash said enhancing a unified GCC position remained "an absolute necessity" in the face of threats affecting the security and stability of member states.

He said there was "no alternative" other than rising to these challenges by uniting ranks to defend sovereignty and safeguard national achieve-



UAE Presidential Court

President His Highness Sheikh Mohamed Bin Zayed Al Nahyan is received by Sheikh Meshal Al Ahmad Al Jaber Al Sabah, Emir of Kuwait, upon arriving at Kuwait International Airport yesterday.

ments, based on a shared destiny and common interests.

"That is the message of the UAE and its leadership," he added.

The Gulf Cooperation Council (GCC) condemned the attacks, describing any strike on a GCC member state as "a direct attack" on all member states. It held Iran "fully responsible" for the attacks and their repercussions, and said the international community must guarantee freedom of navigation through the Strait

of Hormuz without imposing any tolls or charges. The renewed diplomatic focus on regional stability came as fighting intensified despite the ceasefire. Sirens sounded at least three times in Bahrain, while missiles targeted Kuwait and Qatar.

90 targets struck

The US military's Central Command said it struck 90 targets across Iran, releasing footage that appeared to show attacks on an airport runway and missile

launchers. In Kuwait, the military said falling debris wounded one person as it intercepted three ballistic missiles, a cruise missile and 10 drones. Bahrain said it shot down incoming projectiles, while Jordan said all incoming fire from Iran had been intercepted. There was no immediate word of damage in Qatar.

The memorandum of understanding signed last month to end the conflict "looks incredibly fragile", but "neither Tehran nor Washington have

better options ahead besides the diplomatic track", said Ellie Geranmayeh of the European Council on Foreign Relations.

The latest attacks, despite the ceasefire, could reflect divisions within Iran's leadership, with hardliners seeking to preserve leverage over the Strait of Hormuz while pragmatists favour a permanent agreement to ease sanctions and revive the country's struggling economy.

— With WAM and AFP inputs

SEE ALSO P6, P-IV

HORMUZ TRAFFIC SLUMPS AGAIN

Traffic through the Strait of Hormuz has fallen sharply since Wednesday, especially through the UN-backed Omani route, analysts said, after vessels were attacked earlier this week and as the United States and Iran traded renewed strikes.

Flows through the strategic waterway reached their highest levels since the start of the war after a truce was agreed between the two sides in mid-June, although they remained at around a third of peacetime levels.

However, the recovery appears to have stalled — just six commodity tankers have crossed so far yesterday, and 21 such vessels transited the waterway on Wednesday, according to Kpler data as of 1430 GMT.

The only day with less traffic since the US-Iran truce was on June 28, when just 19 commodities vessels crossed a day after a tanker was attacked off Oman.

Most ships crossing since Wednesday either switched off their transponders or used the northern Iranian route, which requires Iranian approval to transit.

The southern Omani route, used in past weeks by many vessels not linked to Iran, has been largely avoided since Wednesday. Till evening yesterday, no ships had crossed using that route.

Oil prices and stocks held steadier as calm returned to financial markets worldwide.

— AFP

One last time: A flying lesson that turned tragic

Trainee told to land plane on her own

DUBAI

BY NATHANIEL LACSINA
Senior Web Editor

The lesson had barely begun.

A flight instructor and his student had taken off from a flying school outside Córdoba for what was expected to be another routine training flight. Minutes later, the student found herself flying alone.

According to Argentine prosecutors, 42-year-old instructor **Leandro Andrés Bertazzo** removed his headset, unbuckled his seatbelt and opened the aircraft door while the Cessna was flying at about 850 feet.

Horror moment

He turned to his student one last time. "You know what you have to do. Carry on."

Then he stepped out of the aircraft.

The 22-year-old trainee,



identified only as Rosario, was left alone at the controls. What followed is now at the centre of an investigation that has stunned Argentina's aviation community.

Rosario kept control of the aircraft long enough to bring it back to the airfield safely. After landing, she alerted emergency services and helped investigators identify the area where she believed her instructor had fallen. Bertazzo's body was later found near the town of Toledo in Córdoba province.

The instructor's father told local media that Bertazzo had sought psychiatric treatment before his death.

FRIDAY

Dubai filmmaker reveals latest directorial venture, in our summer special



IN FOCUS

Why Pakistani mangoes are now pricier in UAE but still selling fast | P8-9

Dubai economy grows 2.4% in Q1

Growth driven by wholesale trade, finance and real estate

DUBAI

Gulf News Report

Dubai's economy expanded by 2.4 per cent year-on-year in the first quarter of 2026, with gross domestic product (GDP) reaching Dh232 billion, reflecting continued growth across a broad range of sectors despite an uncertain global economic environment.

The latest figures, released after a revision of the GDP series using updated survey and administrative data in line with international statistical standards, highlight the strength of

Dubai's diversified economy and its long-term development strategy.

Fastest growth

The Human Health and Social Work Activities sector recorded the fastest growth at 17.5 per cent, generating Dh3.6 billion in gross value added and contributing 1.5 per cent to GDP. The Electricity, Gas and Water Supply; Waste Management sector grew 8.4 per cent, reaching Dh4.6 billion and accounting for 2 per cent of GDP. Construction expanded 8.2 per cent to Dh18.7 billion, contributing 8.1 per cent of the economy.

The Financial and Insurance Activities sector emerged as a major growth driver, rising 6.5 per cent to Dh32.4 billion,

increasing its GDP share to 14 per cent and contributing 37 per cent of overall economic growth during the quarter.

Wholesale and Retail Trade remained Dubai's largest sector, contributing 22 per cent of GDP with Dh50.9 billion in gross value added after 2.6 per cent growth. Real Estate Activities expanded 3.1 per cent to Dh26 billion, representing 11.2 per cent of GDP.

Information and Communication grew 2.7 per cent to Dh12.1 billion, accounting for 5.2 per cent of the economy, while Administrative and Support Service Activities sector, valued at Dh10.5 billion, recorded 3.6 per cent growth and contributed 4.5 per cent to GDP.

SEE ALSO P-II



WORLD CUP

Spain favourites but Belgium are no pushovers as they clash in quarters | P15, 16